



THE PARENT'S GUIDE

The Real Numbers Behind Your Child's Future

What the data really says about the school you choose,
and 10 simple routines to raise a confident, capable child.



A LETTER TO PARENTS

You are about to make the biggest bet of your child's life.

Not their first job. Not their college. The classroom they sit in tomorrow morning. Over thirteen years your child will spend more than **15,000 hours** inside a learning environment, and decades of research keep pointing to the same uncomfortable truth: the environment becomes the outcome.

The good news is that you have more leverage than anyone has told you, both in the school you choose and in a handful of small things you can do at home starting tonight. This short guide gives you two things: the real numbers behind how kids actually do in different settings, and ten simple routines that quietly build a confident, well-spoken child.

No jargon. No fear-mongering. Just what the data says, and what to do about it.

— *The team at Raised & Rooted Academy, Katy, TX*

WHAT'S INSIDE

Part 1: The numbers no one shows you, public, private, and micro school outcomes.

Part 2: What actually moves the needle for a child.

Part 3: 10 simple at-home routines that build communication and confidence.

Part 4: The questions to ask before you enroll anywhere.



PART ONE

The numbers no one shows you

It is easy to assume that an average school produces an average result, and that average is good enough. The data tells a harder story, and it starts with how many children are competing for one teacher's attention.

69%

of U.S. 8th graders score below proficient in reading on the national assessment.

NAEP, The Nation's Report Card, 2022

20–30+

students one teacher manages in a typical public classroom.

Nat'l Center for Education Statistics

15,000

hours your child spends in a learning environment, across 13 years.

Avg. U.S. school day × K–12

Why smaller is not just nicer, it is measurably better

The single most studied lever in education is attention, how much of it each child actually receives. When you shrink the group, you change what is possible in the room.

98th

percentile reached by the average student tutored one-to-one vs. a conventional class, the famous “2 Sigma” effect.

Bloom, Educational Researcher, 1984

+4 mo.

additional progress, on average, that small-group tutoring adds over a single school year.

Education Endowment Foundation

~2×

faster progress under high-dosage, small-group instruction in large-scale studies.

Nickow, Oreopoulos & Quan, NBER, 2020

Public, private, and micro school, side by side

It is not only about test scores. The size and intent of a learning environment shape a child's confidence, habits, and the everyday skills that schooling is supposed to build.

What matters to you**Typical public classroom****A micro school like ours**



Group size	20–30+ students per teacher	~6–10 students, low ratio
Pace of learning	Set to the middle of the room	Set to your child
Real-world skills	Rarely taught directly	Built into the week
Is your child truly known?	Often one of dozens	Known by name, daily
Character & confidence	Incidental	Intentional & modeled
Family involvement	Limited	Partnership by design

The part that follows your child for life

Research consistently links stronger academic achievement and school engagement with higher high-school completion, college enrollment, and adult earnings. School choice is not a guarantee, but it is one of the few levers with that kind of long-range association, which is exactly why it deserves real thought rather than a default.

And then there is the part report cards never measure: real-world ability. The capacity to speak clearly, think through a problem, handle money, and recover from a setback. Those skills predict a good life as reliably as any grade, and they are rarely taught on purpose.



PART TWO

What actually moves the needle

If you strip away the noise, almost everything that helps a child comes down to three things working together. A good school maximizes all three. So can a good home.

1. Attention

A child who is seen is a child who can be taught. When an adult notices what a specific child understands and what they do not, learning stops being a guess. This is the entire advantage of a small group, and at home it is simply time and eye contact.

2. The right level of challenge

Growth happens just past the edge of what a child can already do, not far beyond it and not below it. Pacing set to the middle of a room misses most children most of the time. Pacing set to the child keeps them in the zone where effort pays off.

3. Practice that matters

Skills become real through reps in situations the child cares about, explaining an idea, making a decision, owning a responsibility. The routines in Part 3 are built to manufacture those reps in the ordinary moments you already have.

The takeaway

You cannot personally re-create a school at home, and you do not need to. You need a handful of small, repeatable habits that deliver attention, the right challenge, and real practice. Here are ten.



PART THREE

10 routines that build a confident, well-spoken child

Each takes only a few minutes. None require special materials. Pick two to start this week, then add more once they feel automatic.

01 The ten-minute talk-it-through dinner

Conversation is a skill, and skills need reps. A short, device-free meal where everyone shares one high and one low gives your child daily practice in organizing thoughts and listening.

Try this: Go around the table: “best part of your day, hardest part, and why.” Let them finish without correcting.

02 Narrate the why

Children build reasoning by hearing it. When you think out loud, you hand them the language of cause and effect long before they could invent it themselves.

Try this: Next decision you make, say it aloud: “I’m choosing this because...” Then ask what they would choose.

03 The “tell me more” habit

Yes-or-no questions get yes-or-no kids. Open follow-ups stretch a child's expressive language and teach them that their ideas are worth expanding.

Try this: Replace “How was school?” with “Tell me about one thing that surprised you today.”

04 Read aloud, then retell

Re-telling a story in their own words is comprehension, sequencing, and vocabulary all at once, and it works at every age.

Try this: After a few pages or a chapter, ask: “If you were telling this to a friend, what just happened?”



05 One real responsibility

Confidence is built from competence, not compliments. A job a child genuinely owns tells them, every day, that they are capable and needed.

Try this: Hand over one daily task completely, feeding a pet, setting the table, and let them own the outcome.

06 The two-minute pitch

Persuasion is poise under a little pressure. Letting your child make a case, with reasons, builds structure, eye contact, and the nerve to ask for things well.

Try this: When they want something, say: “Give me your two-minute pitch, with three reasons.”

07 Name the feeling first

A child who can name an emotion can manage it instead of being managed by it. Labeling is the first step of self-control and self-advocacy.

Try this: In a hard moment, offer words: “It looks like you're frustrated. Is that it?” Then wait.

08 Money out loud

Numeracy and judgment grow when numbers attach to real choices. Small, regular money decisions teach trade-offs no worksheet can.

Try this: Give a tiny weekly budget for one real choice and let them feel the trade-off, even the wrong one.

09 Boredom on purpose

Self-direction and creativity only appear in unfilled time. A bored child who is not rescued by a screen learns to start, and finish, their own ideas.

Try this: Protect one screen-free, unstructured stretch a day. Answer “I'm bored” with “great, what will you make?”

10 The bedtime reflection

Three small questions turn a day into a lesson and build the growth mindset that carries a child through hard things.

Try this: At lights-out ask: “What went well, what was hard, and what will you try differently tomorrow?”

**Do not do all ten**

Two routines done for a month beat ten done for a week. Consistency is the active ingredient, the same reason a small class works: the same child, seen and stretched, again and again.

PART FOUR

The questions to ask before you enroll anywhere

Whether you are considering us, another micro school, a private school, or staying put, these questions cut through the marketing and reveal how a school actually treats your child.

What is the real student-to-teacher ratio, on an average day, not on paper?

How exactly do you adjust when a child is ahead, or behind, the rest of the group?

Is progress measured by mastery and understanding, or by a pacing calendar?

Which real-world skills, communication, problem-solving, money sense, are taught on purpose, and when?

How, and how often, will I actually know how my child is doing?

How are character, confidence, and resilience developed here, specifically?

What does a typical day look like, hour by hour?

What happens when a child struggles socially or academically, walk me through it?

A simple test

If the answers are specific, your child is likely to be specific to them too. If the answers are vague, your child is likely to be one of many. You are not being difficult by asking. You are being a parent.



ABOUT THE SCHOOL

Raised & Rooted Academy

We are a micro school in Katy, Texas, built around a simple idea: a child who is truly known is a child who can thrive. With just a handful of students per teacher, we challenge each child at their own level, teach the real-world skills the average classroom skips, and partner closely with families. Rigorous academics, real attention, and roots that hold for a lifetime.

Now enrolling for August 2026

We keep enrollment small on purpose, which means spots are limited. If this guide resonated, the best next step is a simple conversation about your child, specifically.

Visit raisedandrootedacademy.com · Call (281) 555-0140

Reply to the email that delivered this guide and tell us about your child. We read every one.



SOURCES & A NOTE

Where these numbers come from

- Reading proficiency: National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP), “The Nation's Report Card,” 2022. Roughly two-thirds of 4th and 8th graders scored below the “proficient” benchmark.
- Class size: U.S. National Center for Education Statistics (NCES), public-school class-size and pupil/teacher-ratio reporting.
- One-to-one instruction: Benjamin S. Bloom, “The 2 Sigma Problem,” Educational Researcher, 1984.
- Small-group tutoring gains: Education Endowment Foundation (EEF), Teaching and Learning Toolkit, “Small group tuition.”
- High-dosage tutoring effects: Nickow, Oreopoulos & Quan, “The Impressive Effects of Tutoring on PreK–12 Learning,” NBER Working Paper, 2020.
- Long-term outcomes: a broad body of economics-of-education research associating achievement and educational attainment with later earnings and life outcomes.

A note on the numbers: figures are drawn from public, widely cited sources and are presented as approximate, rounded for clarity. Studies vary in method and population, and education statistics are updated over time. Treat these as a well-supported picture of the landscape rather than precise guarantees, and follow the citations above to read the originals.

Raised & Rooted Academy · A micro school in Katy, TX · © 2026. All rights reserved.